

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 676

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to honor the legendary country music band Sawyer Brown on the occasion of their fortieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, Sawyer Brown, formed in Apopka, Florida, in 1981 by Mark Miller, Gregg "Hobie" Hubbard, Bobby Randall, Joe "Curly" Smyth, and Jim Scholten, emerged from Don King's road band and went on to become one of the most influential and enduring acts in country music history; and

WHEREAS, the band rose to national prominence in 1984 by winning the inaugural season of *Star Search* with Ed McMahon, captivating America with their electrifying performances and taking home the \$100,000 grand prize and a recording contract with Capitol Records; and

WHEREAS, the band—whose sound was compared to country supergroups like Alabama and the Charlie Daniels Band, yet whose look echoed the raw energy of the Rolling Stones and Aerosmith—blazed their own path in the music industry, combining a high-energy stage presence with a distinct "life songs" ethos rather than traditional love songs; and

WHEREAS, their breakout hit "Leona" in 1984 was soon followed by their first No.1 single, "Step That Step," beginning a remarkable run of over fifty charted singles on the *Billboard* Hot Country Songs chart, including additional No. 1 hits like "Some Girls Do" and "Thank God for You"; and

WHEREAS, throughout the 1980s and 1990s, the band evolved musically, moving from country-pop to more meaningful ballads, and released a string of successful albums including *The Dirt Road*, *Café on the Corner*, and *Outskirts of Town*, many under their longtime label, Curb Records; and

WHEREAS, Sawyer Brown has performed over 6,000 shows, released twenty-four albums and thirty-six videos, and earned eleven major industry awards, including honors from the CMA, ACM, and CMT, as well as the 1985 CMA Horizon Award and Vocal Group of the Year in 1997 from the Academy of Country Music; and

WHEREAS, they have shared stages with legendary artists, including Kenny Rogers, Dolly Parton, the Beach Boys, Ray Charles, and KC of the Sunshine Band, influencing the next generation of stars such as Blake Shelton, Tim McGraw, Dierks Bentley, and Kenny Chesney; and

WHEREAS, Sawyer Brown continues to connect with fans across generations, performing for audiences that now span parents, children, and grandparents alike, creating a unique multi-generational bond through music; and

WHEREAS, 2024 marks the fortieth anniversary of their *Star Search* victory and the launch of an iconic career, which is being celebrated through a forthcoming memoir by Mark Miller, a documentary on the band, and a new album co-produced with Blake Shelton; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor Sawyer Brown for four decades of excellence in music, innovation in the country-rock genre, and unwavering dedication to their fans and craft.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we commend the band's remarkable journey from underdogs to industry icons and celebrate the legacy they continue to build, one unforgettable show at a time.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.